

7B Vocabulary extension

Passive verbs often in the news

- 1** The verbs in the box are often used in news stories. Put them into five groups of verbs with similar meanings. Four of the groups should contain three verbs, one group should contain two verbs. What is the difference between the verbs in each group?

to be damaged	to be murdered	to be burgled	to be arrested	to be killed
to be wounded	to be robbed	to be jailed	to be assassinated	to be injured
to be stolen	to be destroyed	to be hurt	to be held	

- 2** Choose the correct answers in the following news stories.

- a 'Several people were badly ¹ **injured / wounded** and one was ² **murdered / killed** when a bus crashed into a florist's this morning. The bus driver is being ³ **arrested / held** at a local police station for questioning. Witnesses say that he was driving at 60 miles an hour when the accident happened.'
- b 'Eight houses in the same street were ⁴ **burgled / stolen** in the space of one hour yesterday while all the residents of the street were at a garden party. Police believe that more than £100,000 worth of valuables were ⁵ **robbed / stolen**.'
- c 'The family of Geri Baines, who was ⁶ **assassinated / murdered** by her ex-husband a year ago, were angry today when they heard that he had only been ⁷ **arrested / jailed** for eight years, following a psychiatrist's report.'
- d 'Over 80 paintings were completely ⁸ **damaged / destroyed** in a fire at the City Art Gallery last night. Another 120 paintings were badly ⁹ **damaged / destroyed** by smoke and will need very careful restoration.'

- 3** Match the headlines in the box with newspaper articles A–C. Then complete the articles with the correct form of verbs from exercise 1.

Wigs lead police to prisoners Hairdresser's final cut Pop star loses hair

A Two people were slightly ¹ and equipment was badly ² when a hairdresser, Mari Clarke, 23, went 'crazy' with a pair of scissors in a high-street salon yesterday. Manager Jacqui Reeves said: 'I feel sorry for Mari. She's been very depressed since her boyfriend was ³ for three years for armed robbery.' Ms Clarke is being ⁴ for questioning by police.

B Multi-millionaire pop star Frankie Vale came home from a tour of Asia last night to find that his house had been ⁵ and his collection of valuable antique wigs had been ⁶ Tapes of his new album, which comes out next week, were also ⁷ – pieces of plastic and tape were left all over the floor. 'This was done by someone who is jealous of me, and I know who it is,' said Frankie.

C Two men who escaped from Winkfield prison last week, dressed as women, were ⁸ at Manchester Airport yesterday afternoon. Police were alerted when a nearby supermarket was ⁹ by two 'women' – as one of them was escaping, 'her' blonde wig came off. A shop assistant was slightly ¹⁰ when she was pushed to the floor by one of the escaped prisoners.

- 4** Write a news story for one of the following headlines using the passive verbs in exercise 1.

• Flood chaos hits Berlin • Mass murderer dies • Football fans in fight • Burglars robbed